

**We acknowledge the use of OpenAI's ChatGPT as a supportive tool in drafting and refining portions of the text.*

LAND 220 Syllabus

University of British Columbia

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

UBC's Point Grey Campus is located on the traditional, ancestral, and unceded territory of the xwm̓θkw̓y̓m̓ (Musqueam) people. The land it is situated on has always been a place of learning for the Musqueam people, who for generations have shared knowledge, culture, and traditions on this territory.

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Title	Course Code Number	Credit Value
Urban Landscape Ecology	LAND 220 (ENVR 220)	3

PREREQUISITES

BIOL 140

INSTRUCTIONAL STAFF

The instructor responsible for course development and delivery is Dr. Natalie Wong (she/her). The teaching team also includes lab co-ordinator Liam Patel (he/him), and teaching assistants, Emily Chen (she/her), Jordan Silva (they/them), and Marcus Reid (he/him), to support your learning and help answer questions about urban ecosystems, environmental monitoring, and landscape ecology.

CONTACTS

Course Instructor(s)	Contact Details	Office Location	Office Hours
Dr. Natalie Wong (instructor)	natalie.wong@ubc.ca	FSC 3120	TBA
Liam Patel (lab co-ordinator)	liam.patel@ubc.ca	FSC 1402	N/A
Emily Chen (teaching assistant)	emily.chen@ubc.ca	TBA	TBA
Jordan Silva (teaching assistant)	jordan.silva@ubc.ca	TBA	TBA
Marcus Reid (teaching assistant)	marcus.reid@ubc.ca	TBA	TBA

COURSE STRUCTURE

Official Course Time: Tuesdays and Thursdays 2:00 to 3:30pm Pacific Standard Time. All assignment and assessment due dates posted are in Pacific Standard Time.

Class structure for 2026: This course is designed to occur synchronously and in-person. Students are expected to attend lectures and labs in person unless otherwise communicated through Canvas.

Lecture materials include topics related to urban ecology, environmental planning, ecosystem monitoring, biodiversity, and sustainability challenges. Materials may be delivered through lecture slides, readings, online modules, videos, field observations, and supplementary resources. Please note that lecture materials are intended to support learning but are not a substitute for attending class sessions in person.

ASSESSMENTS OF LEARNING

Graded exams: The course includes a lecture midterm (25%) and a final exam (35%) covering core course concepts, interpretation of environmental data, and applied ecological reasoning.

Lab participation assignments: Weekly lab activities (15% total) will be graded for completion and participation. Students are expected to engage in collaborative activities and field exercises.

Final assessment: Strong performance in this course depends on active participation, consistent study habits, and engagement with course materials.

Graded activities	Marks
Lecture midterm	25
Lab participation	15
Research reflection assignment	10
Case study project	15
Lecture final	35
Total	100

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Following successful completion of LAND 220, you should:

- Understand ecological interactions within urban and peri-urban environments
- Recognize environmental sustainability challenges associated with urban development
- Understand how biodiversity and ecosystem services contribute to resilient cities
- Interpret environmental monitoring data and urban ecological indicators
- Develop foundational environmental communication and research skills

SCHEDULE OF TOPICS AND ASSESSMENTS

Week	Date	Lecture topics	Lab topics
1	Sep 8-12	Introduction to urban ecology	No labs
2	Sep 15-19	Cities, biodiversity & ecosystems	Urban Vegetation I – Trees & shrubs*
3	Sep 22-26	Environmental monitoring methods	Urban Vegetation II – Ground cover*
4	Sep 29 - Oct 3	Climate resilience and adaptation	Urban biodiversity assessment
5	Oct 6-10	Green infrastructure systems	No labs (Field activity week)
6	Oct 14-17	Urban water systems	Midterm review
7	Oct 20-24	Landscape planning & sustainability Midterm (October 23rd)	Urban planning workshop
8	Oct 27-31	Environmental policy and governance	Community engagement activity
9	Nov 3-7	Ecological restoration	Urban ecology field observations
10	Nov 14	TBA Note: No classes on Nov 10th & 12th	No labs
11	Nov 17-21	Environmental communication	Research project support
12	Nov 24-28	Future cities and sustainability	Case study presentations
13	Dec 1-5	Course review	Final lab activity

This schedule is subject to modifications. Any changes to synchronous events will be announced through Canvas. Assessments and participation activities will be conducted through Canvas or during in-person class sessions.

* Labs may include outdoor components, so students should bring appropriate clothing and footwear.

LEARNING MATERIALS AND TECHNOLOGY REQUIREMENTS

Technology requirements: Students should have access to a computer or tablet capable of accessing Canvas, viewing environmental maps and datasets, and completing assignments.

There are no mandatory textbook requirements for this course and all lecture materials will be supplied through Canvas. The following are optional textbooks and resources for review:

Optional text for lectures:

- Sanders, P. & Hill, J. 2021. *Urban Ecology and Sustainable Systems*. Northern Academic Press.

Optional text for labs:

- Carter, L. 2018. *Field Guide to Urban Ecosystems*. Pacific Environmental Publications.

Digital resources:

- UBC Library environmental databases
- Urban Ecology Research Network resources
- E-Flora BC and environmental mapping portals

LEARNING RESOURCES

Canvas and UBC learning support resources will be used throughout the term to support student learning, assignment completion, and communication with the instructional team.

Students experiencing difficulties with course technologies, assignments, or course materials are encouraged to contact the teaching team early in the term.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students requiring academic accommodations should register with the Centre for Accessibility and communicate accommodation requirements to the instructional team in advance of assessments.

If you require extensions or concessions for assignments or exams, please contact the instructor well before the deadline whenever possible.

COURSE POLICIES

Students are expected to follow UBC academic integrity policies and engage respectfully in course activities, discussions, and collaborative exercises.

The instructional team is available to support your learning, but students are expected to participate actively and remain responsible for their own coursework and deadlines.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

In LAND 220, the use of Generative Artificial Intelligence tools, including ChatGPT and similar platforms, may only be used when explicitly permitted for specific assignments. Students remain responsible for the originality, accuracy, and integrity of submitted work.

Students are strongly encouraged to rely on course materials, scholarly literature, and consultation with the instructional team when completing coursework.

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All materials in this course are the intellectual property of the course instructor or licensed for educational use.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

UBC provides resources to support student learning, accessibility, wellbeing, and academic success.

UBC values academic honesty and students are expected to acknowledge the ideas generated by others and uphold the highest academic standards in all coursework and assessments.

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